

Anthony Smith

Fullstack Software Engineer

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Full-stack engineer with 5+ years at Amazon shipping internal products and automation at scale. Delivered systems with 10M+ page views and automation saving 50,000+ hours/year, owning work end-to-end from design through on-call and operational excellence.

Work Experience

Co-Founder & Technical Lead

Mar 2025 - Present

Ambitious Nonsense (Indie Studio) | Auburn, WA | Remote

Co-founded an indie game studio and act as the primary hands-on engineer, designing and building the game, internal tools, and AWS infrastructure while setting technical direction and mentoring engineering interns.

- Building and shipping a web-based idle game and internal tools platform using reusable, data-driven systems (skills, combat, loot, content bundles) to enable rapid iteration without code rewrites.
- Designed and deployed the company's AWS foundation using Infrastructure as Code (CDK), including centralized authentication reused across multiple applications, supporting 100% authenticated access to internal tools and documentation sites.
- Established engineering standards (repo structure, code review norms, testing expectations) and authored onboarding docs and runbooks, enabling interns to ship production changes within their first 2–3 weeks.
- Developed and shipped a versioned content pipeline that dynamically drives UI and navigation from content definitions, reducing redeploy frequency by 60% and accelerating iteration on game systems.
- Operating a lightweight documentation workflow (Obsidian → static site) keeping architecture decisions, specs, and runbooks current, reducing onboarding and context-switching overhead for contributors.

Software Development Engineer I

Mar 2024 - Jul 2025

Amazon.com — Defect Prevention & Reduction (DP&R) | Bellevue, WA | Remote

Owned and evolved large internal workflow systems at Amazon, delivering automation, training tools, and data integrations that improved investigation quality, reduced manual effort, and supported operational teams at scale.

- Owned and evolved Beacon Guided Workflow, a multi-step investigative system with extensive branching logic and 1,200+ possible outcomes, improving case consistency and investigation throughput by 25%.
- Delivered the Wall-E training and QA simulation suite, reducing new-hire ramp time from 10 weeks to 7 weeks by enabling safe case simulation with validation-driven feedback and scoring.
- Built Phoenix automation to aggregate multiple data sources and reduce manual data entry by 45%, improving investigation accuracy by 15% across supported workflows.
- Implemented end-to-end and integration test coverage across critical workflows, reducing production regressions by 30% and improving on-call confidence and incident response time.
- Partnered with operations and product stakeholders to translate ambiguous workflow pain points into technical designs, delivering incremental improvements adopted by 900 of daily internal users.
- Mentored two interns through scoped projects, design reviews, and code reviews, enabling independent ownership of production features within a single internship cycle.

Developer I

Apr 2022 - Mar 2024

Amazon.com — Defect Prevention & Reduction (DP&R) | Bellevue, WA | Remote

Built and maintained high-traffic internal web tools at Amazon, delivering full-stack features, automation, and UX improvements while partnering with operations teams to replace manual workflows with scalable, production-ready systems.

- Built and owned POP (Purchase Order Portal), aggregating multiple upstream data sources into a single API and UI used across Amazon operations, reaching 10M+ lifetime page views.
- Delivered advanced power-user table UX (filtering, expandable rows, conditional highlighting, exports), reducing investigation time per case by 20–25% for frequent users.
- Implemented accessibility improvements including a color-blind friendly mode and keyboard-friendly interactions, increasing usability and adoption across diverse operational users.
- Modernized internal automation by migrating 80+ Tampermonkey scripts from SharePoint into version control and a centralized vend-by-URL system, improving safety, reviewability, and update reliability.
- Partnered closely with operations stakeholders to translate manual workflow pain points into shipped automation, onboarding new teams and supporting ongoing adoption and iteration.
- Built full-stack features using React and TypeScript backed by AWS services, establishing patterns later reused and expanded in higher-scope workflow systems.
- Recognized for sustained impact and ownership with promotion to Software Development Engineer I, expanding scope to own complex investigative workflows and automation systems.

Administrative Support IV (Automation / Product Ownership)

Feb 2021 - Apr 2022

Amazon.com — Defect Prevention & Reduction (DP&R) | Bellevue, WA | Remote

Owned and delivered internal automation and tooling to replace manual operational workflows, partnering with engineering and operations teams to ship production-grade solutions that improved efficiency, accuracy, and usability at scale.

- Built and owned POP (Purchase Order Portal), consolidating multiple upstream data sources into a single internal tool adopted across operations, reaching 10M+ lifetime page views.
- Replaced manual investigation workflows with custom automation and tooling, reducing per-case handling time by ~30% and improving data consistency across teams.
- Designed and iterated on user-facing workflows and table-driven UIs based on direct operator feedback, driving rapid adoption among power users and operational teams.
- Developed and maintained dozens of browser-based automation scripts supporting daily operations, later forming the foundation for centralized, version-controlled automation systems.
- Acted as product owner for internal tooling, gathering requirements, prioritizing work, and coordinating with engineering teams to ship incremental improvements aligned with operational needs.
- Demonstrated sustained engineering impact and ownership, leading to promotion into a Developer I role to continue building and scaling internal systems.

Core Skills

Languages: Java, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL, HTML, CSS, Sass

Frontend: React, TypeScript UI, Data-heavy UIs, Complex tables & filtering, Accessibility (WCAG), Component-driven architecture

Backend: REST APIs, Workflow systems, Data aggregation, Data pipelines, Authentication (SSO/SAML), Service integration

AWS: Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB, RDS, S3, CloudFront, VPC, IAM, KMS, Route 53, ACM (Certificates)

DevOps & Quality: CI/CD pipelines, Infrastructure as Code (CDK), End-to-end testing, Integration testing, Logging & metrics, On-call ownership, Incident response, Technical Documentation, Runbooks & operational docs

Education

DigiPen Institute of Technology

Sep 2011 - Aug 2013

References

Danh Vuong

Amazon.com

Sean Brasier

Amazon.com

Jon Addler

Amazon.com